

Rolecast — internal mobility before external hiring

The Problem

A company posts a role externally, spends €18,000 and eleven weeks filling it, and the person it hires has a skill profile that three existing employees already have. Those three were never considered, because nobody in the organisation knows what they can do — the HR system records the job title they were hired into, sometimes years ago, and nothing since.

Meanwhile those three employees leave within two years, and the most common reason given in exit interviews is the absence of a path.

The company is paying twice: once to hire from outside, and once to replace the people who left because they were not seen.

Our Solution

Rolecast builds a skills graph of the existing workforce from the work people actually do, and matches it against open roles before those roles are posted externally.

Skills are inferred from project assignments, internal documentation, and the systems people use, rather than from a self-assessment form nobody fills in honestly. When a role opens, the system surfaces internal candidates with a match score and the evidence behind it.

The product exists as a working prototype with two of the four planned data connectors built. The matching model runs on synthetic data today.

The Market

Internal mobility is a large and growing category. Global spend on talent acquisition is estimated at \$200B a year, and the average cost of an external hire in our target markets is between €15,000 and €30,000 fully loaded.

There are roughly 62,000 companies in Europe and North America above 1,000 employees. Every one of them has this problem, every one of them measures it, and internal mobility rate has become a board-level metric at many of them. Regulatory pressure on skills-based hiring is adding to this in three jurisdictions.

The market is the strongest thing about this company and we know it.

Competition

Two large HR suites have internal mobility modules that depend on employees maintaining their own profiles, which they do not. Three startups work on skills inference, all of them in North America.

The Team

Rolecast is currently one founder. I spent three years in talent acquisition at a mid-sized company and left to build this. I am not technical; the prototype was built by a contract engineering team.

I am recruiting a technical co-founder and have had second conversations with two candidates.

Traction

- working prototype, two of four connectors built
- eleven discovery interviews with HR directors, of which eight said they would pilot
- one letter of intent, non-binding, from a 2,400-person company
- no paying customers, no live deployment, no production data

Business Model

The intended model is a per-employee annual subscription of €14 to €22, based on what comparable HR modules sell for and on what the eleven interviews suggested buyers would accept.

At €18 per employee, a 2,000-person company is a €36,000 contract against an external hiring spend that company estimated at €1.9M a year. The value case is straightforward if the matching works.

Go-To-Market

Direct sales to HR directors, starting with the eight companies that said they would pilot.

Funding

We are raising €2M to hire a technical team, complete the connectors, and run three paid pilots.